EXPRESSION OF INTEREST

DIGITAL AND FINANCIAL CAPABILITY TRAINING FOR BISP BENEFICIARIES

EOI REFERENCE NO. 27, KARANDAAZ PAKISTAN

Eligibility and Required Competencies · Relevant Experience and Track Record · Concept Note

Sustainable Development Policy Institute (SDPI)

Center of Adaptive Social Protection and Economic Empowerment (CASPEE)

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1. Financial and Digital Literacy Expertise

Required competency: demonstrated experience designing and implementing financial and digital literacy programs for low literacy and marginalized populations, particularly women.

SDPI has substantial financial and digital literacy expertise and demonstrated experience of designing and implementing financial and digital literacy programs for low literacy and marginalized populations, particularly women.

1.1 Digital and Financial Literacy Trainings (DFLT), Phase II

SDPI has implemented the DFLT Phase II under which the National Rollout of Digital and Financial Literacy Training for 250,000 BISP beneficiary women has been conducted. The training has been delivered nationwide through a two day prototype classroom model at BISP tehsil offices, in cohorts of 20 to 22 beneficiaries, by 237 ASPCs hired on merit. The complete delivery cycle was managed on systems developed in house by SDPI. These include the development of a customized DFLT App for registration, attendance, teaching, pre and post test and a CNIC photo verification process supported by an automated OCR reader. SDPI also developed a live central data dashboard that provided BISP and GIZ, the development partner, with same day visibility of delivery across the country. The classroom training is being reinforced through a digital video intervention via a knowledge product base of 13 high powered animated videos, developed by SDPI in coordination with BISP and GIZ, which is currently reaching 131,000 beneficiaries having their own WhatsApp or access to WhatsApp, through the official WhatsApp API.

The Phase II engagement further extends to the Sindh Chapter, implemented in collaboration with the Sindh Social Protection Authority (SSPA). Under this chapter, DFLT training covers 300,000 beneficiaries in Interior Sindh, comprising 165,000 Agriculture Women Workers in the flood prone districts of Thatta, Badin, Sujawal and Sanghar; 125,000 MAMTA beneficiaries of SSPA across the 15 districts of Interior Sindh, and 10,000 Urban Informal Workers of Karachi (East, West and Central). The DFLT training is also integrated with the vertical interventions of concurrent opening of mobile money accounts of all these 300,000 DFLT trained beneficiaries, so that digital and financial inclusion follows directly from the training. The chapter also includes the enrolment of 25,000 beneficiaries, comprising 15,000 Agriculture Women Workers and 10,000 Urban Informal Workers, into a co contributory saving scheme operated through registered mobile wallets, in which the matching contribution will be given to beneficiaries as an incentive upon monthly saving. This component carries direct relevance to the DFLT, as it moves beneficiaries from account access to account usage and saving behavior.

Delivery under the Sindh Chapter to date records 217,170 registrations, comprising 84,572 field agricultural registrations, 86,151 MAMTA registrations and 46,447 registrations conducted through the university trainers. Of these, 202,903 beneficiaries have been proclaimed and 183,802 have been verified, across 9,834 trainings conducted.

DFLT Phase II comes with a massive size and scope in terms of implementation and resource allocation nationwide. Under the BISP chapter, 237 regular trainers were hired. Under the SSPA chapter in Sindh, close to 412 regular trainers have been hired for the expanded beneficiary volume. In addition, more than 600 university students from the targeted districts of Sindh have been trained and utilized through a University Camp Collaboration Model, which provided a supplementary trained resource pool alongside the regular trainers.

Results of the national rollout: 272,570 women have been registered and 252,700 have been verified as DFLT Graduates. The programme target was achieved on schedule on 31 July 2026, and every graduate stands verified against the BISP NSER registry.

1.2 Digital and Financial Literacy Trainings (DFLT), Phase I

SDPI designed the rollout of Phase I of the Digital and Financial Literacy Trainings for the implementor, BISP. It was a holistic design comprising the workplan, curricula integration, rural and urban segmentation of BISP beneficiaries, and the target distribution of beneficiaries across provinces.

Apart from designing DFLT Phase I, SDPI conducted the Impact Evaluation of DFLT Phase I as a Randomized Control Trial with RCT-DiD panel estimation. The evaluation evaluated 250,000 beneficiaries through a representative sample of 5,280 beneficiary women, nationwide, allocated across one control group and four treatment arms, and measured the effect of adding digital interventions to classroom training. The digital component of the programme comprised a short form animated video series, in which 13 videos were designed by SDPI in collaboration with BISP. The series was disseminated as a six week automated WhatsApp intervention to a representative sample of 1,748 beneficiaries having WhatsApp. Baseline and endline surveys of 5,386 respondents respectively were administered through CAPI, supported by live Google Data Studio dashboards, and complemented with KIIs and FGDs. A live data dashboard was also administered during DFLT Phase I.

1.3 Monitoring & Evaluation of DFLT Pilot - 2023

Dr Fareeha Armughan conducted the Monitoring & Evaluation-GIZ for the National pilot of ‘Digital & Financial Literacy Training (DFLT) Program from 14th Dec 2023 to 31st March 2024. Evaluated the pilot of 7000 Beneficiaries. The Evidence generated led to the design & Roll out of DFLT-Phase-1

1.4 Empowering communities for sustainable livelihoods and improved social protection in Khyber Pakhtunkhwa province, Pakistan

SDPI conducted Hilfe zur Selbsthilfe (Help), Community Appraisal and Motivation Program CAMP & BMZ Germany Feasibility Assessment of “Empowering communities for sustainable livelihoods and improved social protection in Khyber Pakhtunkhwa province, Pakistan”. Executed a Social Protection feasibility study via OECD-DAC around sustainable livelihoods improvement initiatives, among vulnerable population with a focus on females in 05 Newly Merged Districts of North-western province and Tribal belt of Pakistan.

2. Content Development and Sector Methodology

Required competency: proven capability developing blended physical and digital training curricula and content for low literacy, women centric audiences, and experience working with relevant ecosystem actors, including SBP, social safety net programs, banks, mobile banking operators, telecoms, agent and retailer networks, and public sector institutions.

Our team has proven experience in developing blended physical and digital training curricula and learning content for low literacy and women centric beneficiaries under the DFLT programme. A feather in the cap for SDPI is that, in terms of content development, SDPI has actually designed, drafted and written the Sindhi version of the customized DFLT Handbook, which has been approved by the Government of Sindh, SSPA, GIZ and the EU in Pakistan, and leveraged upon 300,000 beneficiaries under DFLT Phase II. SDPI has also revised the DFLT handbook of BISP by penning down an additional 20 pages of content and revising multiple sections, including the digital mobile wallet section.

The training content is designed around practical, accessible and easy to understand learning approaches, including face to face instruction, animated educational videos, role play activities, and customized DFLT training handbooks.

The programme begins with a comprehensive review of the existing financial and digital literacy curriculum to ensure its alignment with the evolving digital payment ecosystem and the specific needs of BISP beneficiaries. The adapted curriculum places particular emphasis on ATM usage, mobile to bank account linkage, safe and convenient withdrawal of payments, fraud prevention, digital financial security, and complaint and grievance redressal mechanisms. Beneficiaries are guided on how, where, and through which channels to register complaints in the event of issues involving banks, payment systems, agents, or other actors participating in the payment process.

Under a simple, practical, learner centered and hands on training methodology, the ATM demonstration prototype replicates the basic ATM withdrawal process and enables beneficiaries to practice each step in a safe and controlled learning environment before independently using an actual ATM.

To extend learning beyond the classroom, the programme also developed recorded audio lectures, animated learning videos, and digital learning materials that beneficiaries can access repeatedly according to their convenience. In future, an IVR based learning mechanism will be explored to enable beneficiaries, including those without smartphones or internet access, to listen to selected lessons through a basic mobile phone. The digital content has been progressively developed and localized in Urdu, Punjabi, Sindhi and Pashto to improve comprehension and ensure greater inclusion of beneficiaries from diverse linguistic backgrounds.

The team has the technical capacity and flexibility to continuously adapt and update the training handbook, curriculum, recorded lectures, animated content, and other learning materials in response to programme requirements, field based learning, emerging beneficiary needs, technological developments, and donor priorities.

3. Digital Channel Deployment

Required competency: demonstrated capability to design and deploy IVR, SMS, short form video, and digital media content at scale in low connectivity environments.

3.1 Short form video

In 2024, a short form animated video series was developed for the DFLT programme. Six videos were designed by SDPI and BISP, with an average length of around four minutes, and seven additional videos were designed by SDPI. The series covers savings, budgeting, fraud management, gender equality, climate awareness and the use of feature phones, and is prepared for low literacy viewers in Urdu and local languages. SDPI developed an automated delivery application on the official WhatsApp Business API and disseminated the series to a representative sample of 1,748 beneficiaries as a six week intervention, with scheduled dispatch and per recipient delivery logs. The same delivery system is currently being used to disseminate the video series to 131,000 beneficiaries as the digital video intervention of DFLT Phase II.

3.2 SMS

At the launch of the video intervention, SDPI arranged with BISP for an official SMS to be sent to the beneficiaries from 8171, the BISP number that beneficiaries recognize and trust, informing them that the videos would be received on WhatsApp and requesting them to watch the videos. Sequencing an official SMS from a trusted government number ahead of the digital delivery contributed materially to uptake. SDPI applies this arrangement as a standard practice for beneficiary communication and additionally has the capability to establish dedicated SMS campaigns in house.

3.3 IVR

SDPI has the in house capability to design and set up IVR services for beneficiaries, including recorded menus in Urdu and local languages with key press navigation suitable for users who cannot read.

3.4 Digital media content in low connectivity environments

The DFLT App developed by SDPI for Phase II was engineered for low connectivity environments. Asynchronous syncing is built into the application, so that forms, attendance records and training assets are captured offline and synchronized when connectivity becomes available, with embedded timestamps preserving the integrity of records captured offline. Training content for trainer capacity building is carried within the app in H.265 compressed format, which reduces file sizes and allows material to move over weak networks and low end devices. The application operated through the connectivity gaps of Balochistan and rural KP throughout the Phase II rollout without loss of records.

3.5 Supporting evidence

Representative samples of the deployed content and channels are annexed to this submission, comprising sample videos from the DFLT series. Annexx (Video Series links are attahced in the annexx)

4. Project Management and M&E Capability

Required competency: demonstrated strength in field coordination, progress documentation, output verification, and data quality assurance.

Project management and monitoring and evaluation are institutional functions at SDPI rather than arrangements assembled for a single programme. The same management structure, field coordination model, verification discipline and data quality controls have been applied across nationwide assignments for BISP, the Government of Sindh, the Government of Punjab, PHIMC and UNFPA, spanning social protection, financial and digital literacy, property and cadastral survey, and health research. The four capabilities below are therefore evidenced from across the portfolio, with the DFLT programme presented as the most directly comparable assignment.

4.1 Field coordination

Under DFLT Phase II, SDPI operated a three layered monitoring mechanism combining physical and digital monitoring. The structure comprised Provincial Coordinators at the provincial level, DFLT Implementation Coordinators in the field, and an independent Quality Assurance team working separately from the delivery structure. In addition, eleven coordinators seated at BISP headquarters carried out digital monitoring through random video calls into live training sessions and through checks of the digital attendance. The central dashboard displayed the exact location at which each training was being delivered, which allowed sessions to be verified remotely while in progress.

The field coordination arrangements applied under DFLT build on the structures SDPI established under the door to door NSER survey for BISP, described in Section 7.3. Under that assignment SDPI recruited, trained and coordinated 9,917 field staff in Cluster 2 and 8,673 field staff in Cluster 3, across 21 districts and 79 tehsils of Punjab, through a tiered structure of master trainers, divisional M&E coordinators, district information technology officers, area coordinators, supervisors, field monitors and social mobilizers, with each layer carrying a defined reporting line and the field data monitored centrally as it was collected.

The same coordination model is applied outside the social protection sector. Under the CLICK assignment in Karachi, SDPI established a main coordination office in the city supported by eight Team Support Centres serving as regional hubs for logistics, data quality, monitoring and equipment maintenance, and by Field Support Centres at union council level, coordinating a field force of 741 trained staff with around 50 percent female representation across 73 union councils. Enumeration areas were divided into manageable blocks of approximately 200 parcels each, delineated using GIS and spatial analysis, and teams worked to structured route maps. Under the PULSE assignment in Lahore, SDPI recruited, trained and deployed field teams for a cadastral survey covering 10 tehsils, with more than 2,500 personnel trained on digital survey methodologies, quality assurance and safeguard protocols, and provided coordination support for community outreach in over 200 villages. Across these assignments the principle is consistent, namely a layered field structure with defined reporting lines feeding a central monitoring system, and it is the arrangement proposed for this assignment.

4.2 Output verification

Output verification under the recent DFLT programmes, Phase I and Phase II, has been applied at two levels, the verification of participation and the verification of learning.

Participation has been verified within the training process itself. A beneficiary is registered on day one and is marked as a DFLT Graduate only when she attends on day two. For the day two attendance the DFLT App

permits only a live camera capture, and the trainer is required to photograph the beneficiary CNIC at the venue. The timestamp and location are retrieved from the photo metadata and used as a data quality metric. SDPI further developed the DFLT OCR, an automatic CNIC reader that verifies the CNIC registered on day one against the photograph uploaded on day two. Through this process, 272,570 registrations resulted in 252,700 verified DFLT Graduates.

Learning has been verified through pre and post test, which measures the output of the training against the input delivered. Every beneficiary answers a short structured test before the session and the same test after the session, both administered on the DFLT App, so that the change in her score reflects what the session itself imparted. Under DFLT Phase I this instrument recorded an increase in correct responses from 49.4 percent before training to 70.7 percent after training. A rapid assessment form and an opening show of hands exercise are also recorded on the app, which establish the starting position of each cohort on basic literacy, numeracy, phone use and account ownership. Pre and post test results are recorded against the beneficiary, the session, the trainer and the district, so that training quality can be assessed at each of these levels rather than through attendance figures alone. Where the recorded gain for a session falls outside the expected range, the session is referred for audio review under the quality assurance arrangements described below.

Output verification against a defined target is applied on survey assignments in the same way. Under CLICK, each record captured carried GPS coordinates, a photograph of the structure and complete questionnaire responses, with CNIC verification applied where available, and delivery was measured against the estimated target of 1,050,000 properties, against which 1,290,103 property forms covering 1,519,311 property units were captured and synchronized. Under the NSER survey, enumeration was measured against household targets calculated from census data, with Cluster 2 delivering 5,516,691 households against a target of 5,320,390.

4.3 Data quality assurance

Under the DFLT phases, data quality controls have been applied at the point of capture. Geofencing is built into the DFLT App and locks form entry to a one kilometer vicinity of the approved venue, so that the trainer must be present at the venue for the forms to be filled. An audio audit layer operates behind the delivery. Out of 16,323 training sessions conducted under Phase II, 13,753 sessions carry saved audio audits and 9,453 audits have been listened to in full by the Digital Quality Assurance coordinators. In addition to the teaching audits, the beneficiary registration audios are also audited.

Data quality arrangements were applied in the same manner under DFLT Phase I. The baseline and endline surveys were administered through Computer Assisted Personal Interviewing, with the instrument piloted and translated into local languages before deployment, and the panel was constructed by matching respondents across the two rounds on CNIC. Training delivery under Phase I was monitored by SDPI evaluators across 94 training sessions in 30 districts of the four provinces, with balanced urban and rural representation, covering training quality, content relevance, facilitation effectiveness, training materials and implementation fidelity under standardized data collection protocols.

Equivalent controls are applied across the wider portfolio. Under CLICK, respondent consent, CNIC verification where available and strict interviewer neutrality were enforced through standard operating procedures, enumerators followed structured route maps using the left hand rule with serpentine movement so that no parcel was omitted or duplicated, and the eight Team Support Centres carried a dedicated data quality function alongside logistics and monitoring. Under PULSE, cadastral survey operations were supported by quality control, health and safety compliance and systematic reporting

mechanisms. Under the Sehat Sahulat study and the D4D assignments with UNFPA, data was collected on survey applications with structured validation, and the quantitative work was subjected to formal statistical checks including covariate balance testing under Propensity Score Matching.

4.4 Progress documentation

Under DFLT Phase I, the progress of the baseline and endline surveys was documented on live dashboards maintained on Google Data Studio, with a separate dashboard for each round. These recorded completed interviews against target, province and tehsil wise coverage, urban and rural distribution and consent status as the survey progressed, and were available to BISP and the development partners while data collection was under way.

Progress reporting under Phase II runs on a custom dashboard developed on Node and Express, with the backend built by the SDPI DFLT team. The system documents each event in the data flow and keeps logs across the pipeline. Three types of timestamps are captured from the trainer side and seven types of timestamps are maintained in the database, which allows every reported figure to be traced to its time, location and source.

SDPI applies the same standard of documentation on assignments delivered for other clients. Under CLICK Project, every captured record was geo tagged and synchronized to the client management information system, providing the Government of Sindh with a continuously updated record of survey progress. Under the Sehat Sahulat study, the survey was administered on a software application and data dashboard developed by the SDPI team. Under PULSE Project, systematic reporting mechanisms were established alongside the field operation. The documentation and reporting arrangement proposed for this assignment follows the same design, and is intended to serve as the reporting backbone for the third party monitoring and evaluation firm engaged by Karandaaz.

5. Qualified and Relevant Team Composition

Required competency: availability of a technically qualified team spanning financial literacy, digital tools and DFS, gender and community engagement, training and facilitation, and field operations.

The proposed team is drawn from the personnel who have delivered DFLT Phase I and DFLT Phase II, and spans programme leadership, data analysis, digital tools and dashboards, financial sector expertise, provincial field operations and information technology. Curricula vitae are provided with this submission.

Name	Role	Relevant experience
Dr Fareeha Armughan	Team Lead	Has led DFLT Phase II which is training 550,000 Women benefeciaries in Pakistan (250,000 BISP Benefeciaries & 300,000 Agri Women, MAMTA and Urban informal workers in interior Sindh).She also led DFLT Phase I as Team Lead. Served as Senior Consultant, Monitoring and Evaluation, for GIZ on the national pilot of the Digital and Financial Literacy Training programme from 14 December 2023 to 31 March 2024, evaluating the pilot of 7,000 beneficiaries, where the evidence generated led to the design and rollout of DFLT Phase I. Served as Lead Researcher for Hilfe zur Selbsthilfe (Help), the Community Appraisal and Motivation Programme (CAMP) and BMZ Germany on the feasibility assessment titled Empowering Communities for Sustainable Livelihoods and Improved Social Protection in Khyber Pakhtunkhwa Province, Pakistan, executing a social protection feasibility study under the OECD-DAC criteria on sustainable livelihoods improvement initiatives among vulnerable populations, with a focus on females, in five Newly Merged Districts of the north western province and the tribal belt.
Dr Asma Fiaz	Consultant, Data Analyst	Senior Data Analyst of DFLT Phase I and DFLT Phase II, and contributed to nationwide field operations for data precision.
Dr Kamran Khan	Data and Dashboard Expert	Data and Dashboard Expert for DFLT Phase II, where he developed the customized DFLT App and the live central data dashboard. In DFLT Phase I he contributed to the field management of the DFLT impact evaluation.
Syed Sajid Ali	Senior Consultant, NIBAF, State Bank of Pakistan	Economic Research and Policy Advisory
Anam Malik	DFLT Coordinator	Provincial Coordinator, Khyber Pakhtunkhwa, where she managed all operations of KP.
Iffat Rubab	DFLT Coordinator	Provincial Coordinator, where she managed all operations of Sindh and Balochistan under the BISP chapter.
Ehtasham Afzal	IT Expert	Managing the data of the DFLT Phase II Sindh Chapter.
Asma Rubab	DFLT Coordinator	Provincial Coordinator, MAMTA districts, where she managed all operations of MAMTA beneficiaries.

Table 1. Proposed key personnel

6. Geographic Deployment and Delivery Capacity

Required competency: operational infrastructure, field presence, and staffing depth to deliver a large scale, multi phase blended program across urban, peri urban, and remote rural areas of Pakistan.

6.1 Operational infrastructure

SDPI has nationwide geographic deployment and delivery capacity. SDPI has worked in every province of Pakistan with multiple development partners, provincial governments and local partners. Alongside the DFLT and NSER assignments described in Section 7, SDPI has delivered nationwide implementation programmes including Alif Ailaan, Competitive and Livable City of Karachi (CLICK), Punjab Urban Land Systems Enhancement (PULSE), and Data for Development programme. These include two World Bank funded assignments delivered for provincial governments. The assignments are set out below and demonstrate the operational infrastructure available for a programme of this scale.

Programme	Client and assignment	Duration	Contract value (PKR)
CLICK	The Competitive and Livable City of Karachi (CLICK), a World Bank funded project implemented by the Local Government and Housing Town Planning Department, Government of Sindh. GIS based door to door survey of urban immovable properties in Karachi, Lot 1, Districts Karachi East and Malir.	6 Jan 2025 to 5 Jan 2026, extended to 30 Apr 2026	2,160,769,078
PULSE	Punjab Urban Land Systems Enhancement (PULSE) Project, funded by the World Bank (IDA), a Government of Punjab initiative. Android based survey for precise cadastral mapping, Lot 1, Lahore District.	1 May 2025 to 30 May 2026	371,287,649
D4D (2024)	United Nations Population Fund (UNFPA). Data for Development programme, research and survey operations in Punjab, Balochistan and Khyber Pakhtunkhwa.	1 Mar 2024 to 31 Dec 2024	160,708,274
D4D (2025)	United Nations Population Fund (UNFPA). Continuation of the Data for Development programme.	1 Jan 2025 to 31 Dec 2025	114,612,799
D4D (2026)	United Nations Population Fund (UNFPA). Continuation of the Data for Development programme.	1 Jan 2026 to 31 Dec 2026	128,347,602
Alif Ailaan	Nationwide education campaign and district level education reporting. [Client, assignment details and contract value to be inserted.]	-	-

Table 2. Nationwide implementation programmes delivered by SDPI

Under CLICK, Karachi was divided into three lots and, following a competitive procurement process conducted in accordance with World Bank guidelines, Lot 1 covering District Karachi East and Malir was awarded to the joint venture of LMKR and SDPI. The survey employed a Computer Assisted Personal Interviewing approach using android based handheld devices pre loaded with the CLICK GIS based data collection application. Enumerators followed structured route maps using the left hand rule with serpentine movement, capturing GPS coordinates, photographs of each structure and complete questionnaire responses, with respondent consent, CNIC verification where available and strict interviewer neutrality enforced through standard operating procedures. The target area covered 73 union councils in eight blocks, divided into manageable blocks of approximately 200 parcels each, delineated using GIS and spatial analysis along streets, roads and natural boundaries. A main coordination office was established in Karachi, supported by eight Team Support Centres serving as regional hubs for logistics, data quality, monitoring and equipment maintenance, and by Field Support Centres at union council level. Ahead of enumeration a social mobilization and awareness campaign was carried out, comprising courtesy meetings with elected

representatives, government officials, union council members, community influencers and religious leaders, 365 banners and standees displayed at union council offices, Team Support Centres and high footfall points, 450,000 pamphlets and posters distributed in Urdu, and four branded publicity floats touring the arterial roads, bazaars and peri urban settlements of both districts. Under this assignment 750 handheld devices and around 1,000 kits were procured, and a field force of 741 trained staff with around 50 percent female representation was deployed. A total of 1,290,103 property forms and 1,519,311 property units were captured, geo tagged and synchronized to the CLICK management information system, against an estimated target of 1,050,000 properties.

Under PULSE, SDPI implemented Lot 1 for Lahore District, conducting an android based cadastral survey covering over 2.05 million land parcels across 10 tehsils to support the accurate digitization, verification and mapping of land parcel information. The assignment established the operational foundation for GIS based cadastral mapping and digital land record management in Lahore. Substantial progress was achieved through the recruitment, training and deployment of field teams, with more than 2,500 personnel trained on digital survey methodologies, quality assurance and safeguard protocols, alongside robust quality control, health and safety compliance and systematic reporting mechanisms. Coordination support was also provided for community outreach activities, including awareness announcements and banner dissemination in over 200 villages. The project closed ahead of its planned completion owing to the unavailability of planned parcel information with the client. The technical capacity and implementation systems established under the assignment strengthened institutional readiness for large scale digital land governance initiatives and demonstrated the feasibility of technology driven land information management in Punjab.

Under the D4D programme with UNFPA, SDPI conducted the study Drought and Deluge: The Silent Sufferings of Women and Girls in Climate Change. This was a comprehensive study conducted to generate evidence on the linkages between climate change and SRH and GBV, examining the effects of climate induced disasters, particularly floods and droughts, on women's health, while factoring in social and gender dynamics. The survey was conducted in selected districts of Balochistan, Khyber Pakhtunkhwa and Punjab, covering 1,200 households in total, and was complemented by primary data analysis, focus group discussions, in depth interviews and stakeholder consultations. The findings reveal that climatic disasters significantly disrupt access to SRH services, heighten GBV risks, and exacerbate maternal and child health complications due to damaged infrastructure, displacement and economic stress. The study underscores the urgent need for gender inclusive disaster response strategies in Pakistan.

Also under the D4D programme, SDPI conducted the GBV and SRH Integration at Health Facility Baseline Evaluation. This baseline study was conducted to assess the needs, priorities and access barriers related to Sexual and Reproductive Health and Gender Based Violence services among women, adolescents and marginalized populations in refugee and host communities. The study covered targeted districts in Punjab, Balochistan and Khyber Pakhtunkhwa, reaching over 5,000 households. The findings highlight the prevalence and key drivers of GBV, along with the barriers, that is cultural stigma, economic constraints and limited mobility, that restrict women's and girls' access to services. The study also assessed health facility readiness and found gaps in infrastructure, staff training, and the integration of SRH and GBV services. Based on these findings, a set of baseline indicators, a health facility preparedness index and an action plan were prepared to guide future interventions and track progress over time.

6.2 Field presence

Under DFLT Phase II, SDPI maintained an active field presence in 103 districts and 163 tehsils across all four provinces and the Islamabad Capital Territory, with trainers posted at 147 duty stations rather than

travelling from central locations. The deployment was plotted to maintain a 50 percent urban and 50 percent rural distribution. Delivery was sustained in remote and difficult areas, including the districts of Balochistan such as Khuzdar, Killa Abdullah and Killa Saifullah, the security constrained districts of Khyber Pakhtunkhwa including Bajaur, Khyber, Mohmand, Bannu and Kurram, the northern areas affected by heavy snowfall and road closures, the conservative localities of Lower Kohistan, Pattan and Bankand, the flood prone districts of interior Sindh, and dense urban localities of Karachi such as Manghopir, Orangi Town and Gulshan. The field structure comprises Provincial Coordinators, 25 DFLT Implementation Coordinators carrying out in person monitoring, and the Quality Assurance team, in addition to the trainer corps.

Field presence at a larger scale was established under the NSER survey described in Section 7.3, which required simultaneous coverage of 21 districts and 79 tehsils of Punjab. Field teams traversed 30,141 enumeration areas in Cluster 2 and 34,319 enumeration areas in Cluster 3, covering 184 blocks and 132 blocks respectively, and operated at the level of individual households across both urban and rural blocks.

6.3 Staffing depth

SDPI has recruited and managed field forces at the scale this assignment requires. Under the NSER survey, 9,917 field staff were recruited and registered in Cluster 2 and 8,673 in Cluster 3, and were trained and deployed in the categories of master trainers, divisional M&E coordinators, district information technology officers, area coordinators, enumerators, listers, supervisors, field monitors and social mobilizers. Under DFLT Phase II, 237 regular trainers were hired for the BISP chapter against a merit framework agreed with BISP from a pool of 9,734 open applications, drawing on the BISP resource pool of ASPCs, CRM and CF, with the merit criteria weighted at 20 percent for Matric, 20 percent for Intermediate, 40 percent for Bachelor's, 10 percent for Masters and 10 percent for DFLT Phase I experience. A further 412 regular trainers were hired for the SSPA chapter in Sindh, and more than 600 university students were trained and utilized through a university camp arrangement as a supplementary resource pool. The hiring pipeline, the plotting procedure for urban and rural balance, and the Training of Trainers programme conducted at national level are all in place, which allows the trainer corps to be scaled for the volume proposed under this assignment while applying the same selection standard.

7. Summary of Relevant Experience and Track Record

SDPI has been continuously engaged in financial and digital literacy programming, women centric training delivery and social protection research in Pakistan. The population served under these engagements is the same population targeted under the potential assignment, that is, BISP beneficiary women and comparable low income households.

SDPI has worked on DFLT Phase I with BISP, and DFLT Phase II with BISP and the Sindh Social Protection Authority, along with the collaborating partners EU, GIZ, CERP, OPM, SRSO, HANDS, PAIDAR Sindh and TVET, and has experience working with relevant ecosystem actors. DFLT Phase II especially involves interaction with banks, mobile banking operators and telecom agent and retailer networks. Four relevant assignments are summarized below along with client references.

7.1 Digital and Financial Literacy Training (DFLT) Phase II, National Implementation

Client and partners	Duration	Geography
Benazir Income Support Programme (BISP) and Sindh Social Protection Authority (SSPA), supported by the European Union and GIZ	October 2025 to August 2026	103 districts, 163 tehsils, 4 provinces and ICT

Table 3. DFLT Phase II, assignment summary

Scope: national rollout of Digital and Financial Literacy Training for BISP beneficiary women, delivered through a two day prototype classroom model at BISP tehsil offices in cohorts of 20 to 22 beneficiaries. SDPI was responsible for the full delivery cycle, comprising trainer recruitment against a merit framework agreed with BISP, Training of Trainers, nationwide field deployment, beneficiary registration and verification, quality assurance, and reporting to BISP and the development partners. The assignment was carried out on systems developed in house by SDPI, namely the customized DFLT App for registration, attendance, teaching and pre and post testing, an automated OCR reader for CNIC verification, and a live central data dashboard providing same day national visibility. Classroom delivery is reinforced by a digital video intervention of 13 animated videos disseminated through the official WhatsApp API. The assignment extends to the Sindh Chapter, delivered with the Sindh Social Protection Authority, covering 300,000 beneficiaries in interior Sindh together with concurrent mobile money account opening and a co contributory saving scheme for 25,000 beneficiaries.

Results: under the national rollout, 272,570 women were registered and 252,700 were verified as DFLT Graduates, with the programme target achieved on schedule on 31 July 2026 and every graduate verified against the BISP NSER registry. Under the Sindh Chapter, 217,170 registrations have been recorded, of which 202,903 have been proclaimed and 183,802 verified, across 9,834 trainings. Delivery covered 103 districts and 163 tehsils across all four provinces and the Islamabad Capital Territory.

Duration: October 2025 to August 2026.

Reference: [Johanna Knoess, Head of Adaptive Social Protection GIZ, johanna.knoess@giz.de]

7.2 DFLT Phase I, Randomized Impact Evaluation and Digital Video Intervention

Client and partners	Duration	Geography
Benazir Income Support Programme (BISP)	2024 to 2025	16 tehsils, 8 districts, all four provinces

Table 4. DFLT Phase I, assignment summary

Scope: SDPI designed the rollout of DFLT Phase I for the implementor, BISP, covering the workplan, curricula integration, rural and urban segmentation of BISP beneficiaries and the target distribution of beneficiaries across provinces. SDPI further conducted the impact evaluation of the programme as a Randomized Control Trial with RCT-DiD panel estimation, assessing 250,000 trained beneficiaries through a nationwide representative sample of 5,280 beneficiary women allocated across one control group and four treatment arms, in order to measure the effect of adding digital reinforcement to classroom training. Baseline and endline surveys of 5,386 respondents were administered through Computer Assisted Personal Interviewing, supported by live Google Data Studio dashboards and complemented by key informant interviews and focus group discussions. SDPI also produced the digital component, comprising a short form animated video series of 13 videos designed in collaboration with BISP and disseminated as a six week automated WhatsApp intervention to a representative sample of 1,748 beneficiaries, announced through an official SMS issued from the BISP 8171 number.

Reference: [Johanna Knoess, Head of Adaptive Social Protection GIZ, johanna.knoess@giz.de]

7.3 Door to Door National Socio Economic Registry (NSER) Survey, Clusters 2 and 3

Client and partners	Duration	Geography
Benazir Income Support Programme (BISP), under World Bank financing	1 April 2019 to 31 December 2022	21 districts, 79 tehsils of Central and Southern Punjab

Table 5. NSER Survey Clusters 2 and 3, assignment summary

The National Socio Economic Registry is the database on which BISP eligibility is determined. It was first built from the national Poverty Score Card survey of 2010 and 2011, which collected the socio economic and welfare status of almost 27 million households, and it records household size and composition together with the education, employment, disability, health, occupation and assets of household members. Since the socio economic condition of a household changes over a five to seven year period, the BISP Act and the BISP Operational Manual require the registry to be updated periodically. For the national update, Pakistan was divided into eight clusters. SDPI was mandated to carry out the survey in Cluster 2, comprising the Lahore, Faisalabad and Sargodha divisions of Central Punjab, and in Cluster 3, comprising the Sahiwal, Multan and Dera Ghazi Khan divisions of Southern Punjab. This is the same registry against which BISP beneficiary status is verified today, including the NSER verification applied to DFLT beneficiaries.

The survey was conducted door to door using Computer Assisted Personal Interviewing, with android based applications used for listing and enumeration and with household targets calculated from the 2017 Census data. The scope required complete geographical and demographic coverage of both clusters. The figures achieved in each cluster are set out separately below.

Indicator	Cluster 2, Central Punjab	Cluster 3, Southern Punjab
Divisions covered	Lahore, Faisalabad, Sargodha	Sahiwal, Multan, Dera Ghazi Khan
Districts	11	10
Tehsils	46	33
Blocks	184	132
Field staff recruited and registered	9,917	8,673
Android tablets provided	4,300	3,600
NSER printed field kits provided	4,300	3,600
Enumeration areas traversed	30,141	34,319

Indicator	Cluster 2, Central Punjab	Cluster 3, Southern Punjab
Households listed	4,649,172	4,714,284
Households enumerated	5,516,691	5,608,852
Achievement against target	4 percent above the target of 5,320,390 households	27 percent above the targeted households

Table 6. NSER Survey, delivery figures by cluster

In both clusters SDPI organized the capacity building of the management team and the field staff. The categories trained were master trainers, divisional M&E coordinators, district information technology officers, area coordinators, and enumerators, listers, supervisors, field monitors and social mobilizers at district and tehsil level. Field staff in both clusters were additionally provided with digitally printed unique QR receipts for issuance to surveyed households.

Results: both clusters were delivered above the assigned household targets. Cluster 2 enumerated 5,516,691 households against a target of 5,320,390 households, and Cluster 3 enumerated 5,608,852 households against an estimated universe of 4.41 million households.

Project title: National Rollout of National Socio Economic Registry Update, Clusters 2 and 3. Contract value: PKR 2,287,084,812. Duration: 1 April 2019 to 31 December 2022. Reference: Noman Ali, ODPS-NSER, Benazir Income Support Programme, noman.ali@bisp.gov.pk, 0321 5045760.

7.4 Sehat Sahulat Program, Social Health Protection and the Household Economy

Client and partners	Duration	Geography
Punjab Health Initiative Management Company (PHIMC), under the GIZ and BMZ Research Hub for Pakistan, coordinated by GFA Consulting Group and I-SAPS	Completed July 2025	6 districts, 12 tehsils, 24 urban and rural UCs, Punjab

Table 7. Sehat Sahulat Program study, assignment summary

SDPI conducted a study on the benefits and costs of the Sehat Sahulat Card for poor households in Punjab, whose enrolled population largely corresponds to the BISP beneficiary base. The study assessed the impact of the programme on out of pocket health expenditure and catastrophic health spending, on household saving behavior, and on beneficiaries willingness to pay under co payment and premium based insurance models. A quasi experimental design was applied using Propensity Score Matching, Seemingly Unrelated Regression and Ordered Logistic Regression, on a survey of 1,200 households covering programme utilizers and matched non utilizers, along with an additional willingness to pay sample of 384 respondents. The survey was administered on a software application and data dashboard developed by the SDPI team.

Results: the study found significant reductions in out of pocket expenditure and stronger saving behavior among programme participants, and recommended pairing the programme with financial literacy interventions and co contributory models.